James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Growth marketer who has been the first or early marketing hire at several startups since 2018, across Africa, North America and Europe. I build acquisition channels from nothing and judge them on what they produce further down the funnel. I built an affiliate partner program from scratch on PartnerStack, ran creator and influencer partnerships in an acquisition mix that kept customer acquisition cost under $0.50, and built partnership and event programs that produced hundreds of qualified leads. I have also been the creator a brand pays: my newsletter sells sponsored product showcases to software companies. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/homa.

Selected Achievements:

- Built Reform's affiliate partner program on PartnerStack from scratch: recruiting, incentives, tracking and swipe assets. A co-marketing partnership with Zuko produced **11% of new pipeline**.
- Ran influencer and creator partnerships in Cecure Intelligence's acquisition mix: customer acquisition cost **under $0.50**, **20,000+ community members** and **10,000+ users** across five African countries.
- Generated **1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months** at Bujeti (YC W23), including **200+ from events and partnerships**. New B2B customers grew **500% in Q1 2024**.
- Lifted trial activation **34%** and trial-to-paid conversion **21%** at Reform with a repositioning and a Pro Plan free trial.
- Ran a sponsored creator showcase in my newsletter for Forage Mail: **36% to 41% open rates** and **13+ verified trial sign-ups**.

KEY SKILLS

Growth: Creator & Influencer Programs, Affiliate & Partner Programs, Growth Experiments, Top-of-Funnel Acquisition, Referral Programs, Co-Marketing, Events

Execution: Campaign Writing, Positioning & Messaging, Lifecycle & Onboarding, Paid Social & Search, Landing Pages, Attribution & Funnel Reporting

Tools: PartnerStack, GA4, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, HubSpot, Mixpanel, Meta & TikTok Ads, Google Ads, Brevo, Webflow, Claude Code, n8n

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate, and sell sponsored product showcases to software companies.
- Run a paid-ads services business with three specialists, who deliver client work through a documented handoff, review and reporting system.
- Built a paid-acquisition system that judges campaigns on backend sales instead of ad-platform reports. It caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Built the affiliate partner program on PartnerStack from scratch, with an incentive framework for creators and agencies.
- Ran the Zuko co-marketing partnership, which produced 11% of new pipeline.
- Repositioned the product around lead conversion: 34% lift in trial activation and 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor pages.
- Launched the Pro Plan free trial across web, email and in-app: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built partnerships that produced 14% of new qualified pipeline.
- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function as an early marketing hire, across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months, 200+ of them from events and partnerships, and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer.
- Ran influencer and creator partnerships in the acquisition mix, alongside partnerships with AWS, Google and Microsoft.

- Launched the CIL Academy across five countries with customer acquisition cost under $0.50: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort, at 2x to 3x return on ad spend.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads and 629 demos: $3.4M in open deal value.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech, consumer brands and service businesses

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across four countries): 50% more sales qualified leads from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition at about 8x return on ad spend.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0